

Hardik Gaikwad

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EDUCATION

Jabalpur Engineering College — B.Tech in Information Technology

2023 – 2027

CGPA: 7.69 (up to 6th Semester)

Jabalpur, India

Bal Bhavan School — CBSE

Class XII: 90.8%, Class X: 90.2%

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, C++, JavaScript, Bash, SQL

Frameworks & Libraries: Django, Django REST Framework, React, Streamlit, pikepdf

Databases & Cloud: PostgreSQL, Supabase, AWS S3, Cloudinary

Developer Tools: Git, Docker, Linux, VMware, VirtualBox

Core Concepts: Data Structures & Algorithms, REST APIs, Object-Oriented Programming, Networking, Web Applications

Security: Web Application Security, OWASP Top 10, Vulnerability Assessment, Network Enumeration, Exploitation

PROJECTS

PrivShare — **End-to-End Encrypted File Sharing** (GitHub) | (Live Demo) | *Python, Django, DRF, PostgreSQL, AWS S3*

- Built a secure file-sharing application with a Django REST backend, PostgreSQL database, client-side AES-GCM-256 encryption, and cloud-based object storage.
- Integrated AWS S3 through django-storages and implemented streamed file downloads using **StreamingHttpResponse**, supporting files up to 200MB without loading entire files into server memory.
- Designed token-based file access using UUID4 identifiers, authenticated encryption for tamper detection, and automated 6-hour file expiration to manage temporary resources.

XSScan — **Context-Aware Reflected XSS Scanner** (GitHub) | *Python, AsyncIO, HTTP*

- Developed an asynchronous vulnerability scanner that discovers domain-scoped targets and systematically tests GET/POST input vectors using context-specific payloads.
- Built a response-analysis pipeline that parses HTTP responses into DOM trees to identify payload reflection and determine whether injected input is interpreted in its browser execution context.
- Implemented configurable rate limiting, connection pooling, and custom request headers to improve scanning efficiency and support testing of authenticated endpoints.

GetPYQJEC — **Crowd-Sourced PYQ Compilation Platform** (GitHub) | *Django, Django REST Framework, React, Vite, Supabase, pikepdf*

- Led backend development in a team to build a centralized platform for organizing and accessing Previous Year Question Papers across college branches, semesters, and subjects.
- Designed and implemented a Django REST API supporting structured metadata and file-management workflows for the React frontend.
- Implemented on-demand PDF compilation with **pikepdf**, allowing users to generate subject-wise or semester-wise question paper bundles by year range without manual compilation.

Home Cybersecurity Lab & Network Simulation Environment | *pfSense, Kali Linux, VMware*

- Built a virtualized network environment using VMware and pfSense to simulate segmented attacker and target networks and gain practical experience with routing, firewall configuration, and network isolation.
- Deployed vulnerable environments including VulnHub machines, OWASP Broken Web Applications, and DVWA to perform systematic enumeration, exploitation, and privilege-escalation exercises.

CERTIFICATIONS

eJPT (eLearnSecurity Junior Penetration Tester) — Certificate

- Completed hands-on penetration testing assessments involving reconnaissance, enumeration, vulnerability identification, exploitation, privilege escalation, and post-exploitation.

TryHackMe Security Learning Paths — Profile (Global Top 4%)

- Ranked in the global top 4% on TryHackMe; completed Pre Security, Cyber Security 101, and Jr Penetration Tester paths covering networking, systems, web applications, and security fundamentals.

VOLUNTEERING

VulnCon — **Security Conference (Core Team Member)**

- Contributed to video editing and media content creation, coordinated event coverage across photographers and videographers, and served as a point of contact between the Media and Social Media teams.